

M04 MENTAL HEALTH EDUCATION | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Promote mental health awareness and education through the provision of mental health-focused training or education offerings.

Summary :

This WELL feature requires projects to provide education and training to employees and managers to help them better understand how to manage their own mental health and support others.

Issue : There is a need for increased knowledge regarding causes and recognition of different types of mental health conditions, beliefs about treatment for mental disorders and reduction in stigma against those with mental health conditions.^{1,2} The combination of these factors leads to delays in recognition and help-seeking, hinders public acceptance of evidence-based mental health care and denies those with mental health conditions appropriate support from their communities.²

Solutions : Workplace mental health education interventions can help create a more supportive work environment. Enhancing knowledge and awareness can reduce stigmatizing attitudes and discrimination, as well as improve employee mental health via increased and potentially earlier help-seeking.³ Education and anti-stigma interventions have been shown to have a positive impact on participants' own general mental health,³ as well as their behavior toward those with mental health conditions, such as: enhancing perceived confidence and self-efficacy in identifying and supporting a person with a mental health condition, increased likelihood of advising those in need to seek professional help and greater readiness to provide help in a mental health situation.³ A systematic review of Mental Health First Aid training demonstrated increased participants' knowledge regarding mental health, decreased negative attitudes, increased supportive behavior and confidence in helping others and has been shown to be highly acceptable in a workplace setting.^{4,5}

PART 1 OFFER MENTAL HEALTH EDUCATION (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Trainings (in the form of education seminars, workshops or classes) are offered at least twice per year or on demand to regular occupants and meet the following requirements:

- a. Address at least two of the following topics:
 1. Managing personal mental health and well-being, covering topics such as developing mentally healthy habits and self-care practices, fostering relationships and social connections and managing mental health at work.⁶
 2. Common mental health conditions or concerns, covering, at minimum, depression, anxiety, substance use, stress, and burnout, and loneliness and social isolation.
 3. Signs and symptoms of mental health distress, including how to identify emotional distress and appropriately respond (e.g., Mental Health First Aid).⁶
- b. Provided in-person or virtually (live or recorded), in group or individual settings, and through vendors, on-site staff, health insurance plans, community groups or other qualified programs (e.g., Mental Health First Aid).⁷

PART 2 OFFER MENTAL HEALTH EDUCATION FOR MANAGERS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

All managers undergo annual mental health training (in the form of education seminars, workshops or classes) that meets the following requirements:

- a. Addresses at least three of the following topics:
 1. Identifying and reducing workplace stress-related issues (e.g., conducting performance reviews, effective communication skills, personnel management, conflict resolution).⁷
 2. Recognizing common mental health conditions or concerns, covering, at a minimum, depression, anxiety, substance use, stress and burnout, and loneliness and social isolation.⁷
 3. Supporting employee mental well-being using strategies to prevent burnout, low motivation, fatigue, poor work-life balance and other work-related stress issues.⁸
 4. Recognizing employee mental health concerns or crises, including increasing awareness of workplace and community resources available to employees.⁷
- b. Provided in-person or virtually (live or recorded), in group or individual settings, and through vendors, on-site staff, health insurance plans, community groups or other qualified programs (e.g., Mental Health First Aid).⁷

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